



TrustMRR: Where the Bootstrapped Money Is Going

Snapshot — 1,000 revenue-verified startups on TrustMRR (30 Jul 2026). Every number below comes from connected payment data (mostly Stripe) — real MRR, not guesses. This deck tells a short story in four beats:

What's crowded

Categories with lots of founders.

Where the money lives

Revenue concentrated by country and category.

Who's actually accelerating

Which categories are speeding up now.

What that means

How investors and founders should read this.

Everyone's Building AI — But the Money Isn't There Yet

AI is the largest category by count: 197 startups (≈ 1 in 5 of the 1,000).
But AI accounts for only \$1.81M of \$13.47M listed MRR ($\sim 13.4\%$ of MRR
among startups with category data).

Headline: lots of founders, small share of revenue — popularity $\neq$
payoff.



Category Crowding $\neq$ Category Earning



AI — 197 startups

Count: 197.
Revenue share:
\$1.81M MRR
(~13.4% of category-mapped MRR).



SaaS — 66 startups

Generates \$588K MRR (4.4% of total). Higher revenue-per-founder than the larger AI cohort.



Mobile Apps — 52 startups

Smaller count, focused revenue pools.



Productivity — 49 startups

High utility category with concentrated winners.



Marketing — 42 startups

Generates \$444K MRR (3.3% of total) — punching above AI on revenue per founder.



Dev Tools — 37 startups

Infrastructure bets with outsized per-customer value.



Content Creation — 36 startups

Niche creators and tooling companies mixed in.

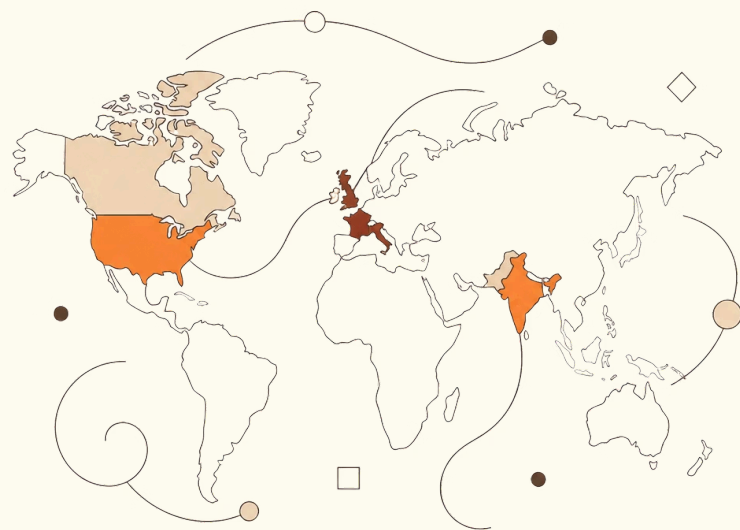


Health & Fitness — 34 startups

Volume exists; winners depend on monetization model.

Takeaway: count is noisy. Evaluate revenue-per-founder, not just category buzz.

Location: Where the Revenue Actually Lives



U.S. — 258 startups (25.8%); \$7.5M MRR (55.7% of total). Dominant in both count and revenue concentration.

France — 79 startups (7.9%); \$894K MRR (6.6%). Efficient second hub.

India — 59 startups (5.9%); \$157K MRR (1.2%). High volume, low revenue per founder.

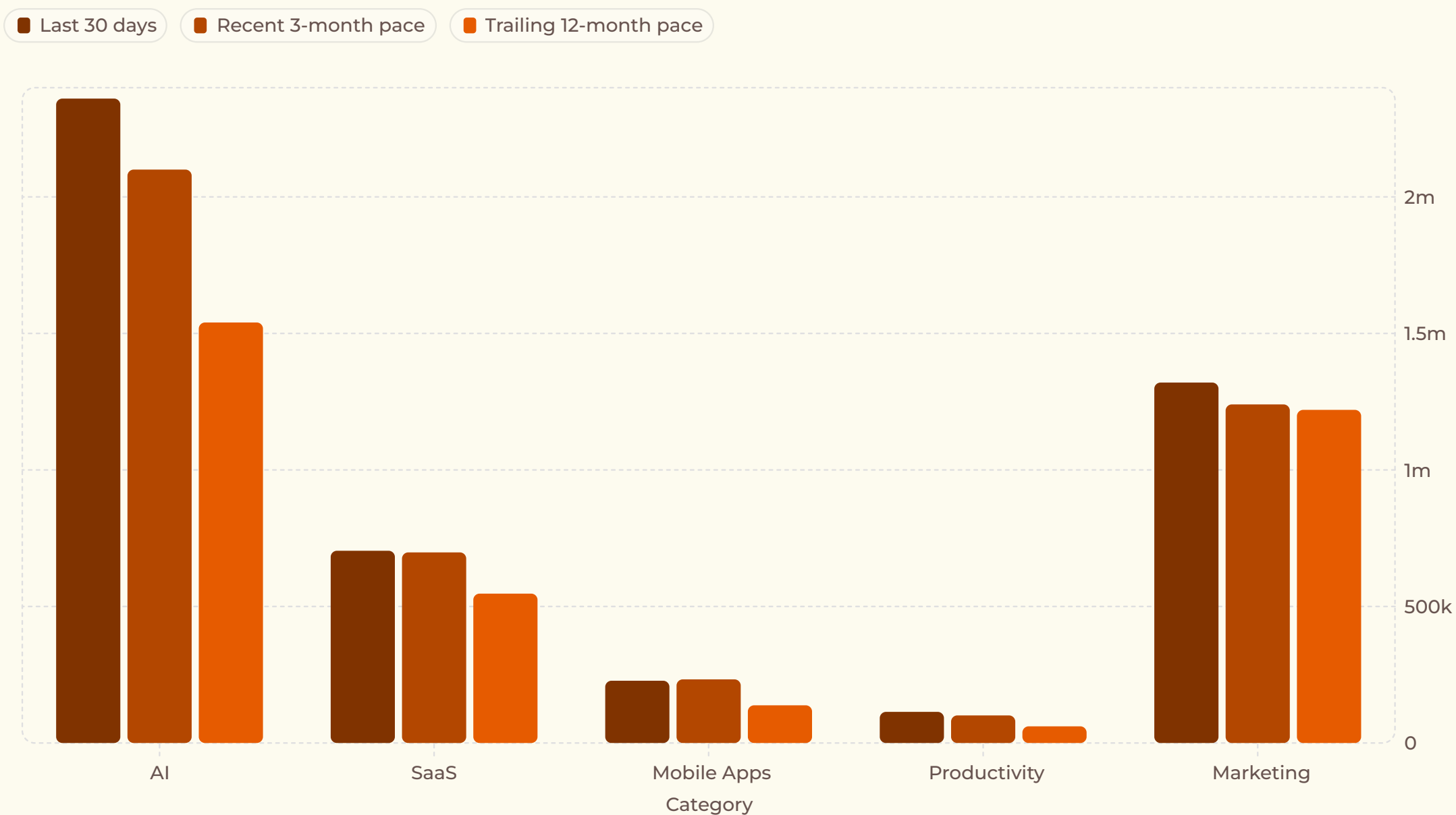
UK — 50 startups (5.0%); \$350K MRR (2.6%). Solid mid-level revenue performance.

Canada — 29 startups; \$366K MRR (2.7%). Small population, strong revenue-per-founder.

□ Frame: the US isn't just large — it concentrates revenue. India is a volume story waiting for monetization to catch up.

Who's actually accelerating — four categories are speeding up now

Compare each category's monthly revenue at three time points: last 30 days, recent 3-month monthly pace, trailing 12-month monthly pace. Numbers below are monthly MRR snapshots (dollars).



Quick read: AI, SaaS, Mobile Apps, and Productivity are accelerating — Productivity shows the steepest relative climb. Marketing is large and steady, not accelerating.

Power Laws: Medians Tell the Real Story



Median: 0%

Mean: +33%

26.2% For
Sale

Caption: The median founder sees flat short-term growth; a few outliers (fast growers) drive average figures upward.

Median

~0% 30-day MRR growth — most startups are flat.

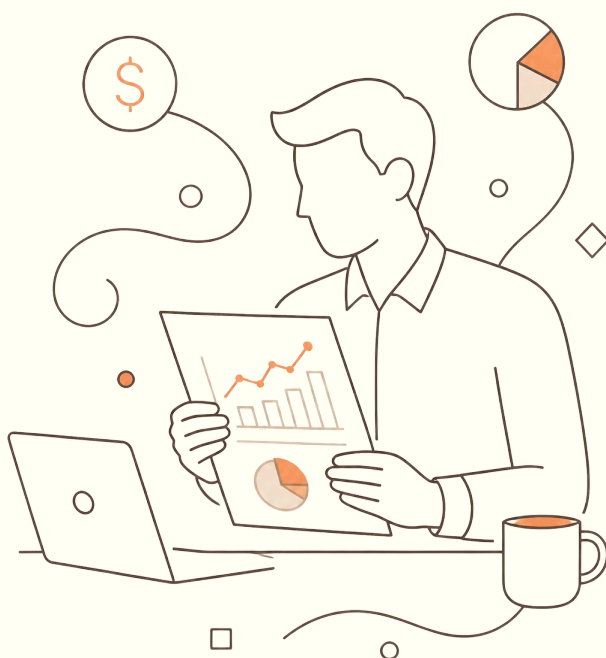
Mean

+33% 30-day MRR growth — skewed by a handful of winners.

Exits / Fire-sales

26.2% listed for sale; avg asking ≈ \$332K — many founders opt to exit over scaling.

So What — Where Founders and Capital Should Look



1. Bet on durable, underpriced categories

SaaS, Marketing, Education and niche B2B verticals show better revenue-per-founder economics than crowded AI. Focus on monetization clarity, not hype.

2. Watch efficient hubs

France and Canada deliver strong revenue relative to founder share — high signal for cross-border deals and hiring.

3. Pick founders, not sectors

Growth is outlier-driven. Because averages are skewed, founder quality and defensible product-market fit matter more than category alone.

📌 Implication for investors: target repeatable monetization and efficient geography; for founders: focus on revenue-per-customer and defensible unit economics.